SECRET MEETING

As they had been carefully instructed, a man and a woman entered a hotel in the Kowloon urban area of Hong Kong, China. It was June 3, 2013, and they had an appointment to keep with someone they had never met or spoken to before. All they knew was the barest of information the person had revealed to them in encrypted e-mails and chats. He held a position of authority in the US government, which gave him access to documents detailing secret government surveillance—documents he now wanted to leak to the world.

On the third floor of the hotel, the man and woman asked the first employee they saw whether there was a restaurant open. This was a signal to the leaker, who had told them he would be standing nearby, listening. The man and woman then entered a nearby small room and waited on a couch. Into the room walked a thin man dressed in jeans and a white T-shirt, carrying a Rubik's Cube.

Edward Snowden was a bit of a mystery to the journalists who traveled to Hong Kong to meet with him in 2013.

Copyright © 2016. ABDO Publishing Company. All rights reserved.